

Chaste Morally pure or decent
 Synonyms Decent, Pure
 Antonyms Impure, Indecent
 • *The chaste conduct of the austere person commands respect.*

Cherubic Good natured
 Synonyms Innocent, Angelic
 Antonyms Demonic, Devilish
 • *His behaviour reveals his approach to be cherubic.*

Chide To express mild disapproval of someone, to scold someone gently
 Synonyms Rebuke, Scold
 Antonyms Admire, Praise
 • *Mother chided the son for his rude behaviour with the guests.*

Chronic Happening or existing frequently or most of the time
 Synonyms Persistent, Long standing
 Antonyms Temporary, Mild
 • *She suffers from chronic pain in her knees.*

Churlish Rude, unfriendly and unpleasant
 Synonyms Arrogant, ill-mannered
 Antonyms Gracious, Polite
 • *Churlish behaviour is his trademark.*

Clout Power and influence
 Synonyms Sway, Power
 Antonym Powerless
 • *Hitler was a man of great clout.*

Coalesce To grow together or unite into one; to fuse
 Synonyms Fuse, Join
 Antonyms Split, Breakup
 • *The ice-masses coalesced into a glacier over time.*

Cogent Very clear and easy for the mind to accept and believe
 Synonyms Convincing, Compelling
 Antonyms Vague, Unconvincing
 • *His ideas were cogent and sound.*

Conciliate To end a disagreement or someone's anger by acting in a friendly way or to slightly change your opinion
 Synonyms Appease, Placate
 Antonym Provoke
 • *The nagging child was conciliated by the toys.*

Concomitant Naturally accompanying or associated with something
 Synonyms Linked, Associated
 Antonyms Disassociated, Unlinked
 • *Loss of memory is a concomitant of old age.*

Concussion Temporary unconsciousness or confusion caused by a blow on the head
 Synonym Violent shaking
 Antonym Consciousness
 • *The accident caused the man a severe concussion.*

Condone To accept behaviour that is morally wrong
 Synonyms Accept, Allow
 Antonyms Condemn, Punish
 • *Parents always condone the fault of children.*

Contentious Causing or likely to cause disagreement
 Synonyms Controversial, Argumentative
 Antonym Agreeable
 • *The contentious issue may obstruct the development.*

Contort To twist or bend out of normal shape
 Synonyms Distort, Twist
 Antonyms Straighten, Smooth
 • *He contorted the instrument by rough handling.*

Contrive To invent or make something in a clever or unusual way
 Synonyms Create, Manufacture
 Antonyms Destroy, Ruin
 • *The Defence Ministry contrived a plan to tackle cross border terrorism.*

Conundrum A confusing and difficult question or problem
 Synonyms Dilemma, Quandary
 Antonym Easy-way
 • *Competitive exams make you face conundrums.*

Convene To call together for a meeting or activity
 Synonyms Summon, Call
 Antonyms Disperse, Leave
 • *We convened at the hotel for a seminar.*

Convivial (Of an event or atmosphere) Friendly, lively and enjoyable
 Synonyms Jovial, Pleasant
 Antonyms Sad, Unhappy
 • *The President of the club arranged a convivial cocktail party.*

Copious Ample, producing much
 Synonyms Plentiful, Abundant
 Antonyms Scarce, Meager
 • *The storm produced a copious amount of rain.*



Dabble Take part in an activity in a casual way.

Synonyms Tinker, Dally, Trifle
 Antonym Take seriously

• *Rita dabbled in many things before she got married.*

Dainty Small and graceful
 Synonyms Elegant, Petite
 Antonyms Crude, Ugly
 • *The house looks dainty and beautiful.*

Dank Unpleasantly moist and cold
 Synonyms Wet, Damp
 Antonyms Arid, Dry
 • *He shivered as he entered the dank room.*

Deadlock A situation involving opposing parties, in which no progress can be made; stalemate
 Synonyms Gridlock, Dilemma
 Antonyms Solution, Agreement
 • *The mediator will help the opposing parties end the deadlock so the contract can be signed.*

Debacle A complete failure; a crushing defeat
 Synonyms Fiasco, Failure
 Antonyms Success, Accomplishment
 • *He faced a debacle in yesterday's game.*

Debase To adulterate, to make poor in quality or of less value
 Synonyms Degrade, Devalue
 Antonyms Upgrade, Enhance
 • *Debased commodities are sold in the market.*

Debauch To destroy or damage something so that it is no longer considered good or moral.

Synonyms Abase, Corrupt

Antonyms Ennoble, Uplift

- *Western culture has debauched the moral fabric of our society.*

Debilitate To make someone very weak and infirm

Synonyms Cripple, Disable

Antonyms Strengthen, Enable

- *The virus debilitates the body's immune system.*

Decadence Having low moral standards and behaviour

Synonyms Corruption, Debauchery

Antonyms Ascent, Decency

- *Decadent people are not valued.*

Decimate To kill a large number of (something) or to reduce very heavily

Synonyms Annihilate, Exterminate

Antonyms Bear, Build, Create

- *Population of endangered animals have been decimated.*

Decrepit Worn out or ruined because of age or neglect

Synonyms Dilapidated, Battered

Antonyms Firm, Healthy

- *The building was a decrepit sample of bricks now.*

Defalcate To steal or misuse funds entrusted to one

Synonyms Embezzle, Loot, Filch

Antonyms Appropriate, Receive

- *Public funds are defalcated by leaders.*

Demure (of a woman or her behaviour) Modest; shy; reserved

Synonyms Meek, Bashful

Antonyms Brazen, Shameless

- *Her demure nature gets everybody's attention.*

Deplore To feel or express strong condemnation of something

Synonyms Abhor, Denounce

Antonyms Praise, Commend

- *Public deplored the casual steps taken by the administration for the safety of women.*

Depravity The state of being morally bad, or an action that is morally bad.

Synonyms Perversion, Criminality

Antonyms Goodness, Uprightness

- *People were shocked by the depravity of her actions.*

Deprecate To criticise or express disapproval of something

Synonyms Belittle, Detract

Antonyms Approve, Commend

- *Everybody deprecated the death of the charitable man.*

Deride To laugh at someone or something in a way that shows you think they are stupid or are of no value.

Synonyms Ridicule, Mock, Disdain

Antonyms Admire, Approve

- *He was derided at for his strange ways.*

Desperado A desperate or reckless person, especially a criminal

Synonyms Bandit, Villain

Antonym Civilised

- *Law must punish the desperado.*

Despot A ruler who has total power and often uses it in cruel and unfair ways.

Synonyms Tyrant, Oppressor

Antonym Democrat

- *Hitler was one of the biggest despots.*

Desultory Lacking a plan, purpose or enthusiasm

Synonyms Aimless, Chaotic

Antonyms Organised, Systematic

- *He wandered around, cleaning up in a desultory way.*

Detract Diminish the worth or value of something

Synonyms Belittle, Decrease

Antonyms Commend, Compliment

- *Numerous errors in the book detracted the reader's attention.*

Devious Showing a skilful use of underhand tactics to achieve goals

Synonyms Unfair, Fraudulent

Antonyms Honest, Fair

- *The minister was a devious politician.*

Devolve 1. Transfer of power to a lower level

2. Pass into a worse state; degenerate

Synonyms Delegate, Pass on

Antonyms Centralize, Improve

- *In a democratic system, power is devolved to the local level.*

Diabolic Extremely evil

Synonyms Cruel, Atrocious

Antonyms Kind, Moral

- *The police quickly mobilised to track down the diabolical serial killer.*

Diffident Modest or shy because of a lack of self-confidence

Synonyms Bashful, Meek

Antonyms Bold, Confident

- *He is too diffident to work in a company.*

Disapprobation Strong disapproval, typically on moral grounds

Synonyms Deprecation, Disapproval

Antonyms Approval, Approbation

- *Sherry was used to constant disapprobation of critics.*

Disconcert to make someone upset; unsettle

Synonyms Perplex, Baffle, Bewilder

Antonyms Assist, Calm

- *The whole experience had disconcerted him.*



Earmark Designate funds or resources for a particular purpose, procure

Synonyms Attribute, Designate

Antonym Disallocate

- *The government earmarked a huge package for agriculture*

Ebullient Very happy and enthusiastic; exuberant

Synonyms Cheerful, Exuberant

Antonyms Unhappy, Depressed

- *The man seems to be ebullient on his success.*

Edifice A large impressive building; a system that has been established for a long time

Synonyms Monument, Building

- *The glass edifice is an architectural wonder.*

Effeminate Womanish; Feminine, Unmanly

Synonyms Effete, Unmanly

Antonyms Masculine, Manly

- *He had a high and somewhat effeminate voice.*

Effete Weak and Powerless

Synonyms Unmanly, Effeminate

Antonyms Manly, Powerful

- *His effete body looks pale.*

Effusive Expressing gratitude, approval or pleasure in a way that shows very strong feeling

Synonyms Gushing, Unrestrained

Antonyms Restrained, Reserved

- *The coach was effusive in praising Tendulkar.*

Emaciated Very thin and weak, usually because of illness or extreme hunger

Synonyms Thin, Skeletal

Antonyms Chubby, Fat

- *Chronic diseases make one emaciated.*

Embodiment someone or something that represents a quality or an idea exactly

Synonyms Personification, Incarnation

Antonym Exclusion

- *Mother Teresa was often regarded as the embodiment of selfless devotion to others.*

Enervate to make someone feel weak and without energy

Synonyms Debilitate, Devitalise

Antonyms Strengthen, Energise

- *We were enervated by the lengthy discussion.*

Enjoin To instruct or urge someone to do something or behave in a particular way

Synonyms Urge, Command, Insist

Antonyms Obey, follow

- *The boss enjoined the workers to do the best.*

Ensconce To make yourself very comfortable or safe in a place or position

Synonyms Settle, Install

Antonyms Unsettle, Exhibit

- *He ensconced in his new abode there.*

Entree Admittance; the right to enter something

Synonyms Entry, Ingress

Antonyms Exit, Refusal

- *Entree to the country club is through sponsorship.*

Entropy Lack of order or predictability, gradual decline into disorder

Synonyms Break up, Collapse

Antonyms Improvement, Order

- *The mishandling of the situation led to entropy.*

Ephemeral Existing only for a short time

Synonyms Fleeting, Transient

Antonyms Enduring, Lasting

- *Fame in the show business is ephemeral.*

Epoch A long period of time, especially one in which there are new advances and great changes

Synonyms Era, Span, Age

- *The development of the steam engine marked an important epoch in the history of industry.*

Equitable Treating everyone fairly and in the same way.

Synonyms Unbiased, Reasonable

Antonyms Partial, Biased

- *He is fighting for a more equitable distribution of funds.*

Excruciating Intensely painful

Synonyms Acute, Agonising

Antonyms Painless, Calm, Easy

- *The Utrakhand disaster was an excruciating experience for the victims.*

Expatiate Speak or write in detail

Synonyms Expound, Lecture

Antonyms Compress, Abridge

- *It is useless to expatiate upon the beauty of nature to one who is blind.*



Facade The principal front of a building that faces on to a street or open space

Synonyms Front, Elevation, Frontage

Antonyms Rear, Back

- *The gallery's 18th century facade attracted the visitors.*

Facetious Treating serious issues deliberately with inappropriate humour

Synonyms Flippant, Frivolous

Antonyms Serious, Formal

- *The facetious boy was chided.*

Facile 1. Ignoring the true complexities of an issue; superficial
2. A success which is easily achieved

Synonyms Superficial, Hasty

Antonyms Thorough, Profound

- *This problem needs more than just a facile solution.*

Factitious Artificial, not natural

Synonyms Fake, Bogus

Antonyms Natural, Real

- *His explanations were all factitious.*

Fallacious Based on a mistaken belief; misleading

Synonyms Erroneous, False

Antonyms Genuine, True

- *Someone is spreading fallacious information.*

Fastidious Very attentive to and concerned about accuracy and details; very concerned about matters of cleanliness

Synonyms Pains-taking, Meticulous

Antonyms Careless, Sloppy

- *His culinary skills are fastidious.*

Fatuous Stupid, not correct or not carefully thought about

Synonyms Silly, Foolish

Antonyms Sensible, Intelligent

- *All his reasons appeared fatuous to me.*

Feckless Lacking initiative or strength of character; irresponsible

Synonyms Useless, Worthless

Antonyms Responsible, Competent

- *Country does not need feckless people.*

Fecund Very fertile

Synonyms Fertile, Fruitful

Antonyms Unproductive, Infertile

- *The soil of the plains is fecund.*

Feisty Having or showing exuberance, strong determination and lack of fear

Synonyms Courageous, Gutsy

Antonyms Cowardly, Dull

- *Mountaineering needs feisty people.*

Felicity 1. Intense happiness
2. The ability to find appropriate expressions for one's thoughts
Synonyms Bliss, Delight, Eloquence
Antonyms Sorrow, Unhappiness
• *Felicity is a bliss to be enjoyed.*

Fester (of a problem or negative feeling) become worse or more intense, especially through long term neglect or indifference
Synonyms Smoulder, Aggravate
Antonyms Flourish, Grow
• *It is better to express your anger than let it fester inside you.*

Fetid Smelling extremely bad, Foul
Synonyms Smelly, Putrid
Antonyms Aromatic, Perfumed
• *The carcass of the dog has made the surroundings fetid.*

Fidelity Honest or lasting support, Loyalty, Faithfulness
Synonyms Loyalty, Constancy
Antonyms Dishonesty, Infidelity
• *Friendship survives on fidelity.*

Fiend 1. Cruel, inhuman
2. An enthusiastic or devotee of a particular thing
Synonyms Barbarian, Ogre
Antonyms Angel, God
• *His hands were trembling as if he was some sort of fiend.*

Flack Strong criticism or opposition
Synonyms Criticism, Censure
Antonyms Appraisal, Praise
• *Dowry should be a matter of flack.*

Flagrant Too bad to be ignored
Synonyms Heinous, Shameless
Antonyms Magnificent, Wonderful
• *The killing of innocent villagers is an example of flagrant ways of Maoists.*

Foment To cause trouble to develop
Synonyms Incite, Instigate
Antonyms Deter, Discourage
• *He was accused of fomenting violence.*

Fortitude Courage in pain or adversity
Synonyms Courage, Bravery
Antonyms Cowardice, Fear
• *Fortitude makes you a winner.*

Frenzied Madly excited or uncontrolled
Synonyms Wild, Frantic
Antonyms Controlled, Calm
• *The office was a scene of frenzied activity this morning.*



Gainsay To deny or contradict a fact or statement
Synonyms Dispute, Oppose
Antonyms Accept, Confirm
• *There is no gainsaying the fact that they have built a great building.*

Gall Bold and impudent behaviour
Synonyms Impudence, Insolence
Antonyms Cordiality, Politeness
• *After borrowing my car, he had the gall to complain about its seats.*

Gallant 1. Brave; heroic
2. (Of a man) polite and kind towards woman
Synonyms Valiant, Unafraid
Antonyms Timid, Rude
• *Although she lost, she made a gallant effort.*

Garble To make words or messages unclear and difficult to understand
Synonyms Muddle, Jumble
Antonyms Obvious, Clear
• *The terrified child gave a garbled account of the incident to the police.*

Garish Too bright or colourful
Synonyms Gaudy, Bright
Antonyms Dull, Unflashy
• *The decoration looked garish.*

Gauche Awkward and uncomfortable with other people, specially because young and lacking in experience
Synonyms Awkward, Gawky
Antonyms Elegant, Sophisticated
• *She had grown from a gauche teenager to a self assured young woman.*

Genial Friendly and cheerful
Synonyms Affable, Cordial
Antonyms Hostile, Unfriendly
• *His genial outpour surprised me.*

Ghastly Unpleasant and shocking
Synonyms Terrible, Horrible
Antonyms Pleasant, Charming
• *The scene of the crime looks ghastly.*

Giddy Having a sensation of whirling and a tendency to fall or stagger.
Synonyms Dizzy, Light-headed
Antonyms Steady, Sensible
• *He was walking giddily.*

Gingerly In a careful or cautious manner
Synonyms Warily, Cautiously
Antonyms Carelessly, Rashly
• *He did the work gingerly.*

Gratify To please someone or to satisfy a wish or need
Synonyms Please, Gladden
Antonyms Dissatisfy, Displease
• *I am gratified by his words.*

Grimace To make an expression of pain, strong dislike, etc in which the face twists in an ugly way
Synonyms Scowl, Frown
Antonyms Smile
• *After falling down, he started to stand up grimacing with pain.*

Grisly Causing horror or disgust
Synonyms Gruesome, Ghastly
Antonyms Pleasant, Attractive
• *The grisly figure made the child cry.*

Grubby Covered with dirt
Synonyms Filthy, Mucky, Grimy
Antonyms Clean, Tidy
• *One must clean off grubby hands before eating.*

Gruff (person's voice) Low and unfriendly
Synonyms Rough, Hoarse
Antonyms Soft, Mellow
• *He speaks in a gruff way, but is really kind.*



Habituated Used to something, especially something unpleasant
 Synonyms Accustom, Adapt
 Antonyms Avoid, Shun
 • Bears can become habituated to people easily.

Haggard Looking exhausted or unwell, especially from fatigue, worry or suffering
 Synonyms Drained, Tired
 Antonyms Fresh, Healthy
 • The athletes looked haggard after the race.

Haggle Dispute or bargain persistently
 Synonyms Barter, Negotiate
 Antonyms Concur, Comply
 • Customers often haggle with the seller.

Hallowed Very respected and praised because of great importance or great age
 Synonyms Holy, Sacred
 Antonyms Cursed, Unholy
 • The site of the ancient temple is a hallowed ground.

Hapless Having no luck; very unfortunate
 Synonyms Unlucky, Ill-fated
 Antonyms Fortunate, Lucky
 • She plays the hapless heroine who is unlucky in love.

Harrowing Extremely upsetting because connected with suffering
 Synonyms Tortuous, Painful
 Antonyms Calming, Comforting
 • The harrowing news reached the village.

Headstrong Very determined to do what one wants without listening to others
 Synonyms Wilful, Strong-willed
 Antonyms Undetermined, Tractable
 • Being headstrong by nature, he did not listen to his wife's advice.

Heady Having a strong exhilarating effect
 Synonyms Exciting, Thrilling
 Antonyms Boring, Dull
 • The party seems heady today.

Hector Talk to someone in a bullying way
 Synonyms Intimidate, Badger
 Antonyms Please, Assist
 • The senior guy was hectoring the junior.

Heedless Not giving attention to a risk or possible difficulty
 Synonyms Inattentive, Oblivious
 Antonyms Needful, Attentive
 • He was driving heedlessly.

Heinous Outrageously evil; horrifying
 Synonyms Wicked, Atrocious
 Antonyms Admirable, Delightful
 • The man is facing charges over his heinous act.

Herald To be a sign of something that is going to come or happen soon
 Synonyms Indicator, Sign
 Antonyms Aforeseen
 • The early flowers are heralds of spring.

Horrendous Shocking; horrible
 Synonyms Dreadful, Alarming
 Antonyms Pleasing, Wonderful
 • Conditions in the refugee camps were horrendous.

Humane Having or showing compassion
 Synonyms Compassionate, Kind
 Antonyms Unkind, Inhumane
 • It is not humane to treat animals cruelly.

Hypothetical Based on a situation that is not real, but that might happen
 Synonyms Imaginary, Theoretical
 Antonyms Real, Actual
 • She described a hypothetical case to clarify her point.



Idolatry Very great admiration or respect for someone, often too great
 Synonyms Reverence, Adoration
 Antonyms Vilification, Condemnation
 • Newton was revered to the point of idolatry.

Impertinent Rude and not showing respect towards someone older or in a higher position than you
 Synonyms Disrespectful, Rude
 Antonyms Polite, Mannered
 • Its impertinent to ask strangers about their private lives.

Implausible Not believable or realistic
 Synonyms Unbelievable, Doubtful
 Antonyms Reasonable, Convincing
 • She's been making implausible claims.

Impolitic Unwise words or actions that are likely to cause offence or problems.
 Synonyms Unwise, Imprudent
 Antonyms Wise, Prudent
 • I thought it impolitic to ask any question about her ex.

Improvident Not giving thought to the future
 Synonyms Heedless, Inconsiderate
 Antonyms Provident, Farsighted
 • He is improvident about his career.

Inalienable Not subject to being taken away from or given by the possessor
 Synonyms Absolute, Inviolable
 Antonyms Changeable, Alienable
 • The group of women wanted equal inalienable rights as men.

Incorrigible Beyond correction or change
 Synonyms Hardened, Hopeless
 Antonyms Correctable, Changeable
 • She is an incorrigible chatterbox.

Incredulous Not able or willing to believe something
 Synonyms Mistrustful, Doubtful
 Antonyms Believing, Credulous
 • Everyone laughed the incredulous stories of the old man.

Indigent Very poor
 Synonyms Penniless, Destitute
 Antonyms Rich, Affluent
 • The heavy losses he incurred in business rendered him indigent.